

EURS

Crèches, etiquette training and parking solutions are but some of the few services for which demand is growing from mall owners. With 300 new malls expected to come up by 2010, such services are proving to be solid growth opportunities for the few aspiring to make it big.



HEMANT CHAWLA

Sarita Sarvria, 48

Express Housekeepers

Specialisation:

Professional housekeeping services

Number of employees: 10,000

Revenues: Rs 50 crore per annum

THEN: Sarvria quit her job as deputy housekeeper at Hotel Taj Mansingh in Delhi and started Express Housekeepers in 1988 with Rs 15,000.

NOW: The company provides housekeeping services, including carpentry, genset maintenance and laundry services, to over 20 malls across the country.

Rs 18 crore for her alone. A report by management consultants AT Kearney estimates that organised retail in India, with a size projected to grow from Rs 50,000 crore now to Rs 2,20,000 crore by 2011, could spend about Rs 4,400 crore—around 2 per cent—on various allied services.

By providing an opportunity in such services, malls are helping small entrepreneurs get bigger and attract more business. "We are witnessing the next wave," says Colonel Ashutosh Beri, head of property and mall management at Jones Lang LaSalle Meghraj (JLLM), which manages around 80 lakh sq ft in 23 malls across India. Malls have not only spurred the growth in retail but also mall-related services. With many large mall-management companies not interested in handling smaller malls in Tier II and Tier III cities, companies such as JLLM and Knight Frank are increasingly tapping local entrepreneurs, who with their low overheads, could easily fill up this gap. Says Sanjeev Gupta, the proprietor of Mélange Mall in Meerut, "Executives of large companies do not wish to settle in small towns such as ours. Moreover, local vendors are better equipped to



RAVISH SAHANI